

Part A — Open research questions

Grouped by theme. * marks questions that are time-critical (the baseline must be collected before late October 2026).

A1. Coping, sacrifice and household bargaining

- – How do households at different income levels cut back after a fuel/transport shock: food quantity, food quality, children’s schooling, healthcare, remittances home, or savings? **In what order**, and does the order differ by who controls the household budget?
- Who inside the household absorbs the cut? Do women and girls eat less, or give up mobility (unaccompanied travel, trips to work, school or clinics) first?
- How much does borrowing increase (NGO microcredit, shopkeeper credit (*baki*), kin, mobile-money loans), and does it become debt that households can’t escape?
- Does kerosene use increase or fall among off-grid and load-shed households, and what replaces it (candles, solar lanterns, darkness)? What does that do to children’s study hours?

A2. Relative deprivation and the pay-scale wedge

- – Do private-sector and informal workers compare themselves to government employees now that the pay scale and the hike landed together? Does that comparison predict grievance, lower trust in the state, or willingness to protest better than their own absolute income loss does?
- Inside mixed households (one government earner, one private or informal earner), how are the gains shared? Do they cause friction?
- Does resentment get framed as *class* (“the rich”), *sector* (“government people”), *party* (“their people”), or *geography* (“Dhaka”)?

A3. Informal transport: the e-rickshaw as the poor’s shock absorber

- Who are the new battery-rickshaw drivers of 2026? What share are displaced farmers, ex-garment workers or returned Gulf migrants? What pushed them from where they were, and what pulled them into driving?
- – How do fare-setting norms form when the official gazette is ignored? Who holds power at the fare negotiation: passenger, driver, garage owner, or local enforcer?
- How is illegal charging governed? What is the informal economy of charging points: who sells the electricity, who protects them, how much do they pay in rents or bribes? How does that change during load shedding?
- If the state cracks down on e-rickshaws, where do those livelihoods go?

A4. Farmers, irrigation and the Boro decision

- – How will farmers decide how much Boro to plant (Nov–Dec 2026) given diesel at Tk 135+, a frozen procurement price and an uncertain supply? Which farmers cut back: sharecroppers, smallholders or large farmers?
- How do irrigation-service markets (pump owners selling water to neighbours) re-price water? Do tenant farmers bear more of the cost than their share?
- Do farming households send members into the cities (to rickshaws or RMG) during this season, feeding back into A3?

A5. Garment workers, time and the city

- How do RMG workers change their commute (walking longer, moving closer to the factory, sharing rooms), and what does that do to their time, safety and health, especially for women on night shifts?
- Does the combined pressure of energy shortage, transport costs and food prices change how workers organise at the factory level (wildcat stoppages, demands for transport allowances)?
- How much do the extra Tk 260–300/month in realised bus fares (~2–2.4% of the RMG minimum wage, README §4b), on top of food pass-through, feed into the demand for a new minimum-wage board?

A6. Legitimacy, blame and protest

- Whom do people blame: the government, BPC, the Hormuz war, India, “syndicates”, or hoarders? How does blame vary by partisanship, sector and information source (TV, Facebook, WhatsApp, YouTube, the local mosque or bazaar)?
- Does the PM’s public apology (5 Sep) and the “tolerable level” framing make the hike more or less acceptable?
- **Moral economy test:** do people accept higher prices when they understand them as justified by the global market, and reject them when they see them as unfair (duty kept in place, pay rises for government employees, rumours of smuggling)? Does the sense of being treated unfairly predict protest better than the size of the price rise?
- How does online sentiment about fuel on Bangla Facebook and YouTube move against real events (hikes, bus fare gazettes, load-shedding peaks)?

A7. Compensation and the state

- – If the government introduces targeted compensation through the Family Card, who is excluded, and why (documentation, mobile-money access, local political gatekeeping)?
- Is cash compensation seen as a *right* or as *charity*, and does that change how legitimate the hike seems?

- Do people prefer universal cheap fuel or targeted cash? Does the answer change when the trade-off is explained?

A8. Comparative and historical

- How do coping and protest in 2026 compare with 2022, the last major hike, among the same kinds of households?
- Why did Nigeria's 2023 subsidy removal, Kenya's 2023 fuel VAT increase, Sri Lanka's 2022 crisis and Bangladesh's 2026 hike produce such different levels of protest?